

Planning a Trip

CHAPTER 12

Supplemental Dialogue for the Beginner Workbook

by Peter Mangiaracina

Beatriz and Wanda are two expatriate Americans living in the Canary Islands. They are having coffee at a coffee shop near work.

WANDA

Hi Beatriz, it's great to see you! How have you been?

BEATRIZ

I'm good, thank you. How about you?

WANDA

I'm doing well, thanks. I'm really excited because I'm planning a trip soon.

BEATRIZ

Business or pleasure?

WANDA

Pleasure. I need to relax.

BEATRIZ

That's great! Where are you planning to go?

WANDA

I'm thinking about going back to my home town, New York City. I haven't been there for a long time, so I'm really looking forward to it.

BEATRIZ

That sounds like a fun trip. Have you made plans yet?

WANDA

Yes, I've already booked my flight.

BEATRIZ

Round trip or one way?

WANDA

Round trip, of course! I have to be back at work in two weeks.

BEATRIZ

Will you stay with family or friends, or at a hotel?

WANDA

I have the opportunity to stay with my brother and his wife in the city, but I don't want to bother them. I'd rather stay in a hotel and give them their privacy. I have plans to have dinner with them a few nights.

BEATRIZ

Did you make reservations for your hotel?

WANDA

Not yet, but I plan to do it soon. I want to make sure I get a good deal.

BEATRIZ

Try to get a hotel outside the city, but close to the subway. Manhattan hotels can cost a lot of money!

WANDA

Yes! I know. I'm looking for a hotel or an AirBnB in Brooklyn or Queens. Both are only a short subway ride to Manhattan.

BEATRIZ

That's a good idea. Two weeks is a long time. How many suitcases are you planning to bring?

WANDA

I'm not sure yet, maybe two. Do you think they charge extra for more than one suitcase?

BEATRIZ

Yes, most airlines do charge extra for two suitcases. You should check with your airline to be sure. You could also just take one suitcase, a carry-on, and wash your clothes in a laundromat in the city, so you don't have to bring a lot.

WANDA

Great idea! Thanks for letting me know. I'll make sure to do that. I'm also trying to decide between a direct flight or one with a layover in Barcelona.

BEATRIZ

If you're in a hurry, a direct flight might be better. But if you have some extra time, a layover can be a nice way to visit Barcelona. It's a fantastic city.

WANDA

That's a good point. I'll have to think about it some more. One thing I do like is that there's no charge for canceling my reservation if I need to. My boss sometimes needs me and maybe I will have to cancel my plans.

BEATRIZ

Ugh! I know! Bosses can really be a pain in the neck!

WANDA

I can't wait! I just want to see my old stomping grounds*.

BEATRIZ

That sounds like a lot of fun. I hope you have a great trip!

**Stomping grounds: A place you used to live and know very well.*